

they choose to enter. The important thing to note is that the lines are blurring and it's an exciting time to be a woman, especially in technology," said Genius Wong, Senior Vice President, Global Network Services and Cloud Enablement, Tata Communications. "For example, At Tata Communications, I am one of the three women on the leadership team, our CFO and CMO are both women who come from the technology industry."

She recognises that gender gap is a challenge in the tech business – women make up only 16 percent of tech jobs globally, according to her. However, Wong believes this can change with organisations such as 'Girls who Code' that work towards closing the gender gap in technology and inspiring girls to pursue computer science by exposing them to real life and on screen role models.

Shweta Aprameya, COO, Airtel M-Commerce Services Limited, says that consumers are more linked to the end state unless there is an emotional connect attached. She further adds, "Speaking



“I would say that it takes a while for a customer to be convinced that a woman can understand and solve technical issues; hence one encounters a lack of confidence initially. It takes both time and effort to build credibility for a woman in technology.”

KV SUDHA
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
SYSTEMS MANAGEMENT ENGINEERING
DELL INDIA

of society at large, I believe there is an increasing awareness that women are the driving force in every field. We have Arundhati Bhattacharya, who heads one of the largest banking institutions. Biotechnology has women like Kiran Majumdar Shaw – a widely acknowledged personality. Google, in its recent diversity report, mentioned that 21 per cent of tech hires last year were women, boosting the overall number of women in technical roles by 1 per cent. This is a clear indication of a paradigm shift enabling higher participation of women in technology companies.”

According to NASSCOM, a trade association for Indian software and services companies, the tide's turning slowly but surely as women entrepreneurs have started to advance a foothold in the startup industry and have begun to make their presence felt. Sangeeta Gupta, Sr Vice President, NASSCOM further adds, "To enhance women's representation in the IT-BPM industry, NASSCOM has been working with the industry to help more women to build successful ventures. As part of our '10,000 startups' initiative, we initiated 'Womentechship' in support with major players in the ecosystem that helps promote and grow entrepreneurial and

innovative women in the tech space. The important thing to do is to create a robust startup and investment ecosystem for women. Hence, as part of these programs we have been organizing various industry connect programs, Hackathons, meetups and tech-talks, where women entrepreneurs can meet women leaders to discuss and share insights on a regular basis”.

GETTING MORE WOMEN INTO TECH

To ensure more women become technologists, Barbara Belpaire, General Manager, TomTom (India), believes it all starts with giving girls access to technology, social media and innovation at home and in school to spark their interest in the technology domain.

“Traditionally in India, girls did not always get the same chances as boys and this should be addressed. Parents need to ensure good education for their daughters and allow them to make career choices for themselves in line with their interests and talents,” Barbara stresses. “Girls should



“The role of women in both technology creation and its adoption is increasing by the day. Women constitute about 34% of India's tech industry today. Product planning and development are benefiting from these increasingly diverse insights. Additionally, the use of technology by women is growing rapidly across the world. Data suggests that women are the bigger decision makers in procuring technology today: women buy 65% and influence 89% of all consumer electronics purchases.”

“I have derived my biggest professional satisfaction from building technology systems that deliver real-world value to the customer. In my first 10 years, I worked on building fraud detection systems for credit cards, healthcare and insurance. These systems helped to detect different fraud patterns in real time. They also helped to detect crooked healthcare providers, who in some cases, were providing unnecessary services to patients. In my current role, I'm helping to build new features for the Indian consumer by partnering with local Indian sellers, thus not only helping the end-customer, but also taking technology to the local sellers and providing new services for them.”

ARATI DEO
SR MANAGER
MACHINE LEARNING & SOFTWARE
DEVELOPMENT, AMAZON.COM

KUMUD SRINIVASAN
PRESIDENT, INTEL INDIA